

Sahyadri Circuit Ride (From Mumbai)

A proper 2-day mountain loop that leaves the city behind and drops you straight into the heart of the Sahyadris.

If you're riding out of Mumbai and want a route that gives you **forest roads, ghats, valley viewpoints, cool hill-station weather, and Konkan-style descents** - this one is a gem.

It's one of those rides where every few hours, the landscape changes completely.

Route

'Mumbai → Mulshi → Tamhini Ghat → Bhore → Varandha Ghat → Tapola → Mahabaleshwar → Ambenali Ghat → Poladpur → Mangaon → Mumbai'

Total Ride

- **Approx Distance:** '450–500 km'
 - **Duration:** '2 Days'
 - **Ride Style:** 'Scenic / Weekend Loop / Ghat-Focused'
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Why This Ride Is Worth Doing

This circuit is a proper **Sahyadri sampler pack**.

You get:

- the **green calm** of **Mulshi**
- the forest charm of **Tamhini**
- the dramatic cliffs of **Varandha**

- the quiet lakeside vibe of **Tapola**
- the cool mountain air of **Mahabaleshwar**
- and the thrilling descent of **Ambenali**

It's the kind of route that keeps resetting your mood every few hours.

My Ride Experience

Varandha Ghat

This stretch was a mixed bag this time.

The road condition in **Varandha** wasn't the best because of **ongoing road work**, so there were enough rough sections to keep speeds in check.

But the reward?

The **sunset from the top** was breathtaking.

The whole valley lit up in gold, the ridgelines went dark against the sky, and suddenly the bad patches didn't matter anymore.

Some views really do **pay back the road**.

Mahabaleshwar Stretch

This was one of the most enjoyable parts of the ride.

The roads around **Mahabaleshwar** were **beautiful**, surrounded by **dense tree cover**, and the atmosphere stayed cool and inviting throughout.

Even in the **mid-day sun**, the climate was surprisingly **pleasant** - which made that section feel less like a commute and more like a proper mountain escape.

Just one of those roads that makes you want to keep going.

What Makes This Route Memorable

- Leaving the chaos of the city behind
 - Watching the terrain shift from plains to deep Sahyadri folds
 - Catching sunset from **Varandha**
 - Riding under thick green canopies near **Mahabaleshwar**
 - Dropping down **Ambenali** into the Konkan side
 - Cruising back with a full head and a fuller heart
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Road Notes

- **Varandha Ghat:** currently rough in places due to road work
 - **Mahabaleshwar:** excellent riding roads and pleasant weather
 - **Ambenali:** fantastic descent, stay disciplined
 - **Mumbai return leg:** can get tiring with traffic after the mountain sections
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Would I Do It Again?

Without a second thought.

This isn't just a "weekend escape" route.

It's one of those loops that reminds you **why you ride in the first place.**